

THE FINAL CHECKPOINT



Spain

champions of the world

GYAN printed Spain to lift the trophy.

Spain lifted the trophy.

PRINTED JUNE 10 AT 13.2% · WON JULY 19, 1-0 OVER ARGENTINA, AET

01 · THE HEADLINE

The name in the middle of the page came true.

The last stage ran July 14 to 19. Spain beat France in Dallas, Argentina came from behind to beat England in Atlanta, England took third in a ten-goal playoff in Miami, and Spain beat Argentina 1-0 in extra time at New York New Jersey Stadium to win the World Cup. Spain is the champion GYAN printed, at 13.2%, and they finished the tournament unbeaten. It is Spain's second World Cup title, sixteen years after their first in 2010.

The stage itself was the model's most mixed since the Round of 16. Two printed calls landed, the Spain semifinal and the Spain title, and two missed, England into the final and France third. The stage scored 5/12 points (41.7%), and the composite Knockout Score closes at 42/96 (43.8%), with winner calls finishing 24/32 (75.0%).

02 · SOURCES AND SCORING

Same rules as every checkpoint.

Results come from FIFA's match centre, cross-checked against ESPN, Sky Sports, Yahoo Sports, FOX Sports, CBS Sports, Al Jazeera, and CNN. All sources agree on every score. Each completed match is worth up to 3 points:

+1 point**The winner call**

The team GYAN printed as the winner of that bracket position won the match.

+1 point**The exact matchup**

Both teams in the tie are the two teams GYAN drew, surviving every upstream reshuffle.

+1 bonus**The perfect tie**

Both at once: right pairing, right winner. The hardest thing a printed bracket can do.

The two semifinals, the third-place match, and the final put 12 points on the table for the stage and lift the running knockout maximum from 84 to 96. The third-place match scores against the page like every other tie: GYAN printed France vs Argentina with France third.

03 · THE LAST FOUR MATCHES

Two semifinals, a bronze, and a trophy, checked against the page.

GYAN's printed advancer was on the field in all four ties. Both semifinals were the exact pairings drawn on page 4; the third-place match and the final each arrived with one swapped name.

RESULT	DATE · VENUE	GYAN'S PRINTED TIE	VERDICT
 France 0-2 Spain 	TUE JUL 14 · DALLAS	FRANCE VS SPAIN, SPAIN TO WIN	EXACT PAIR + WINNER
 England 1-2 Argentina 	WED JUL 15 · ATLANTA	ENGLAND VS ARGENTINA, ENGLAND TO WIN	EXACT PAIR ONLY
 France 4-6 England 	SAT JUL 18 · MIAMI	FRANCE VS ARGENTINA, FRANCE THIRD	MISS
 Spain 1-0 Argentina  AET	SUN JUL 19 · NEW YORK NEW JERSEY	SPAIN VS ENGLAND, SPAIN CHAMPION	WINNER CORRECT

2/4 WINNER CALLS · 50.0%	2/4 EXACT MATCHUPS · BOTH SEMIFINALS	1/4 PERFECT TIES · SPAIN OVER FRANCE	5/12 STAGE POINTS · 41.7%
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Scorers, for the record. Semifinal 1: Oyarzabal 22 pen and Porro 58 for Spain. Semifinal 2: Gordon 55 put England ahead before E. Fernandez 85 and Lautaro Martinez 90+2 turned it for Argentina. Third place: Rice 3, Konsa 18, Saka 37, 45+2 and a late penalty for the hat trick, and Bellingham 90+8 for England; Mbappe 48 and 66, Barcola 54, and Dembele in stoppage time for France, with Mbappe's second making him the World Cup's all-time leading scorer. The final: Torres 106, thirty-seven seconds into the second half of extra time, after Argentina's E. Fernandez was sent off in stoppage time. Spain's expected goals read 1.94 from 20 shots to Argentina's 0.20 from 2, and Emiliano Martinez made 11 saves, a World Cup final record.

Reading the last stage honestly.

The champion call deserves its headline, and the misses deserve their ink. Here is what the last four matches actually said about the model.

The headline call landed.

Everything a printed bracket exists to do comes down to the name in the middle of the page, and GYAN's name was Spain, the narrowest of front-runners at 13.2%. Spain won the tournament without losing a match. One correct call at 13.2% does not validate a methodology, and a model that puts 86.8% elsewhere is not entitled to a lap of honor. But it was the single call the whole publication was built around, and it was right.

The page argued with itself about Argentina, and Argentina proved the argument mattered.

The bracket document flagged England vs Argentina as the tie where the model and its own footballing engine disagree most: the engine alone made Argentina a runaway favorite at 20.3%, while the market-weighted blend slid them to fourth at 8.7% and printed England through. Argentina won that tie in the 92nd minute and reached the final. The engine's favorite made the final; the blend's favorite won it. The most interesting number in the model turned out to sit exactly where the page said it did.

The swapped-opponent pattern finally broke, at 16 straight.

France, printed to beat Argentina in the third-place match, faced England instead and lost 6-4. One night later Spain, printed to beat England in the final, beat Argentina instead. The pattern closes at 17 of 18 (94.4%), carrying the caveats attached to it at every checkpoint: a small sample that mostly tracked favorites beating the teams that upset their printed opponents. It was a tendency, never a law, and the third-place match is where the law ran out.

The board beat the bracket, again.

GYAN's four semifinalists were its top four on the champion board, and the tournament's final standings, Spain, Argentina, England, France, are those same four teams in board order 1, 4, 3, 2. The single printed bracket finished at 43.8%; the probability board underneath it read the top of the tournament almost perfectly. That has been the lesson of every checkpoint, and it held to the last whistle.

Four printed endgame calls, settled.

The quarterfinal checkpoint closed with everything the page still printed fully alive. Here is how each of those calls resolved.

CALL	PRINTED ON PAGE 4	WHAT HAPPENED	SETTLED
SEMIFINAL WINNERS	Spain 🇪🇸 and England 🇬🇧	Spain 🇪🇸 and Argentina 🇦🇷	1 OF 2
THE FINAL	Spain 🇪🇸 vs England 🇬🇧	Spain 🇪🇸 vs Argentina 🇦🇷	FINALISTS 1 OF 2
THIRD PLACE	France 🇫🇷, in a 2022 final rematch	England 🇬🇧, best finish since 1966	0 OF 1
CHAMPION	Spain 🇪🇸 · 13.2%	Spain 🇪🇸, champions, unbeaten	1 OF 1

THE FINAL, ON THE PRE-TOURNAMENT BOARD

Both actual finalists came from GYAN's printed top four: Spain first on the champion board at 13.2%, Argentina fourth at 8.7%, either side of France at 11.2% and England at 9.2%. The final the model printed, Spain vs England, was board 1 vs 3. The final the tournament played, Spain vs Argentina, was board 1 vs 4, and it was also the exact final the model's strength-only engine would have leaned toward, with Argentina its outright favorite. Whichever lens you prefer, the trophy match came from the top of GYAN's list.

4/4

SEMIFINALISTS, AS PRINTED,
THE BOARD'S TOP FOUR

2/2

EXACT SEMIFINAL MATCHUPS,
CALLED MONTHS IN ADVANCE

1/1

CHAMPION · SPAIN,
PRINTED AT 13.2%

06 · THE FINAL KNOCKOUT SCORE

Four rounds on the board, and the board is closed.

The composite runs on the same three layers as always: winner calls, exact matchups, and perfect-tie bonuses, out of 3 points per match across all 32 knockout matches.

STAGE	WINNER CALLS	EXACT MATCHUPS	PERFECT TIES	POINTS
Round of 32	13/16	5/16	3/16	21/48 43.8%
Round of 16	5/8	3/8	2/8	10/24 41.7%
Quarterfinals	4/4	1/4	1/4	6/12 50.0%
Semis, third place, final	2/4	2/4	1/4	5/12 41.7%
Total	24/32 75.0%	11/32	7/32	42/96 43.8%

75.0%

KNOCKOUT WINNER CALLS ·
24 OF 32

82.8%

WHERE THE PRINTED ADVANCER
WAS IN THE TIE · 24 OF 29

43.8%

COMPOSITE KNOCKOUT SCORE ·
42 OF 96

How to read the final composite. Three of every four knockout matches went to the team the bracket printed, and better than four in five where GYAN's printed advancer actually took the field. The exact-matchup and perfect-tie layers stayed strict by design, because a single printed bracket has to survive every upstream reshuffle to land a pairing, and they hold the composite at 43.8%.

Same lesson as every checkpoint, now settled: the model read team strength well all tournament, and the printed page paid the price of being one snapshot of a 100,000-run distribution. The snapshot still got the last name on the page right.

The page is settled.

1 The champion call was right.

Spain, printed at 13.2% as the narrowest of front-runners over France and England, won the World Cup unbeaten, 1-0 over Argentina in extra time. The last call on the page was the one that mattered most, and it landed.

2 The bracket closes at 42/96 (43.8%), the winner layer at 24/32 (75.0%).

The last stage scored 5/12 (41.7%): a perfect tie in the Spain semifinal, the exact England vs Argentina pairing with the wrong winner, a missed third-place call, and the right champion in a final drawn against the wrong opponent.

3 The board read the top of the tournament almost perfectly.

The final four were GYAN's printed top four, both semifinal matchups were exact, and the final standings run Spain, Argentina, England, France, the board's 1, 4, 3, 2. The probabilities, not the single printed path, were the model's best product all tournament.

4 Credit and caveats traveled together to the end.

The swapped-opponent pattern closed at 17 of 18 (94.4%), broken by France in the third-place match, exactly the way small samples break. And the champion call, right as it was, was a 13.2% shot that came in. GYAN said probabilities, not prophecies, and it means it in both directions.